

PARENT TECH QUICK-START KIT

Senior Phone Buying and Setup Checklist

Use this before buying a phone or handing one over. The best phone is the one your parent can use during ordinary moments, not the one with the most features.

Before buying

☐ Can they answer without reading small text?

☐ Can they call family in one or two taps?

☐ Is the monthly cost clear?

☐ Can family help without needing passwords every time?

☐ Does it work with hearing, vision, or hand-use limits?

☐ Is there a simple return path if it fails?

☐ Will this reduce support work or create more?

☐ Can the parent practice before relying on it?

Compare the options

Option	Best fit	Watch out for
Simple phone	Calls and a few contacts.	Texting, photos, maps, and app needs may be limited.
iPhone	Family support, FaceTime, shared photos, accessibility settings.	Too many apps or notifications can confuse the first screen.
Android	Flexible price points and large-screen options.	Settings and manufacturer layouts vary.
Smartwatch	Extra alerts and wrist-based calls.	Battery, wearing habits, and service setup matter.

Setup before handoff

☐ Increase text size, ringtone volume, and contrast.

☐ Add five key contacts to favorites.

☐ Put phone, messages, camera, photos, and maps on the first screen.

☐ Turn off noisy or confusing notifications.

Product page: <https://parenttechchecklist.com/products/parent-tech-quick-start-kit>
Parent Tech Checklist. General technology education only; no device can guarantee safety or emergency response.